

Ria Bahadur

Researcher · Legislative Author · Founder

Stanford University · Science, Technology & Society Honors · Class of 2027

riabahadur.com · LinkedIn · GitHub

EDUCATION

Stanford University | 2023–2027

B.S. candidate in Science, Technology, and Society with Honors. Honors thesis: *Credibility by Design: How Military Wargames Shape Plausibility Judgments*.

CURRENT RESEARCH & EXPERIENCE

Honors Thesis Researcher, Stanford Science, Technology, and Society | 2026–

Research on professional military wargaming, technological change, expertise, and credible expectations about uncertain futures of conflict.

Main Staff, Project Innovation · Hoover Institution | 2025–

Research and synthesis for a national-security study on U.S. scientific innovation, AI leadership, research security, international cooperation, governance, and public trust.

Process Modeler & Operational Analyst · NATO CCDCOE | 2025–

Publicly disclosable analytical role at the NATO Cooperative Cyber Defence Centre of Excellence in Tallinn.

Founder & CEO · Dual-use decision-simulation venture (stealth) | 2025–

Independent venture informed by research in strategic simulation, technological transition, and institutional decision-making.

Founder & Legislative Author · Mission 5355 | 2022–

Created, drafted, and negotiated Washington SB 5355, enacted in 2023; authored Montana SB 107, enacted in 2025; expanded the prevention-education model through additional U.S. and international pathways.

SELECTED POLICY, EDUCATION & PUBLIC-INTEREST WORK

Washington Senate Bill 5355 | Enacted 2023

At seventeen, became the youngest sole author of enacted legislation in a U.S. state. Passed the Washington Senate 48–0 and House 97–0; signed May 4, 2023.

Sexual Violence and Sex Trafficking in the 21st Century | 2022–2023

Project lead and grantee for an open educational curriculum published through OER Commons after a competitive \$16,000 grant.

Washington SANE Guide | 2022

Authored a professional educational resource on trafficking recognition for Sexual Assault Nurse Examiners; in use at Washington State University College of Nursing.

UNESCO Ethics of Neurotechnology Consultation | 2024

Invited through the U.S. Department of State as an Academic (Medical) Stakeholder in the 2024 consultation informing UNESCO's Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology.

SCIENCE, SECURITY & INSTITUTIONAL LEADERSHIP

Wargaming Director · Stanford FACES | 2024–

Founded and leads wargaming programming at Stanford's student-led U.S.–China summit, including public exercises on autonomous weapons, escalation, and nuclear deterrence.

Researcher · Stanford CISAC | 2024–2025

Research on technological change, strategic simulation, and professional wargaming.

Operations Lead · Stanford Student Space Initiative | 2024–2025

Led operational planning, funding processes, cross-team coordination, and external engagement.

Director / Executive Board · Stanford Women in National Security | 2024–2025

Programming, speakers, communications, and community-building across national-security fields.

SELECTED RECOGNITION

FUSE Fellow 2026 | 2026

Selected by the FUSE Committee through the Science and Technology in Society Forum and North American Associates of the STS Forum, with support from the Henry Luce Foundation.

Selected Presenter, Stanford Existential Risks Initiative Symposium | 2026

Selected as 1 of 4 symposium presenters for *From Kriegsspiel to SIGNAL: The Sociotechnical Evolution of Digital Wargaming and Its Implications for Strategic Scalability*.

Cap and Gown Leader Award | 2026

Selected by Stanford's Cap and Gown leadership community.

Stanford Existential Risks Initiative Fellow | 2024

Selected as 1 of 23 fellows for original research on adversarial behavior and research-security vulnerabilities.

National Speech & Debate Recognition | 2019–2023

3rd nationally in Impromptu Speaking; NSDA Academic All-American; 55+ regional awards.

SELECTED CONVENINGS & SPEAKING

Science and Technology in Society Forum Annual Meeting · Kyoto | 2024–2026

Annual Meeting invitee and rapporteur in 2024 and 2025; invited for a third consecutive Annual Meeting in 2026. Rapporteur across sessions on industry-academia-government collaboration, research security, science diplomacy, and scientific trust.

IBM & NAA–STS Forum High-Level Workshop | 2026

Synthesis Author for *Science in Society: A Crisis of Trust*.

National Academies Research Security Roundtable · Hoover Institution | 2024

Participant in the Pacific Regional Meeting of the National Science, Technology, and Security Roundtable.

EARLIER SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH

Pathak Laboratory · University of California, Irvine | 2020–2021

Neural stem cells, Cas9 gene editing, brain organogenesis, Piezo1 mechanobiology, immunostaining, FIJI analysis, and patch-clamp electrophysiology across 100+ files; authored two laboratory protocols.

University of Washington Center for Neurotechnology | 2021

Junior researcher in restorative neurotechnology; acknowledged in peer-reviewed neuroscience research.

Seattle Children's Research Institute · Johnson Laboratory | 2022

Experimental work using genetic mitochondrial-disease models; cited on two industry-research publications arising from the laboratory's work.

Neurological Associates of Washington | 2022

Clinical neurology internship focused on diagnostic evaluation, treatment decisions, and neurological care.

SELECTED PUBLIC WORK

Open Educational Resource

Sexual Violence and Sex Trafficking in the 21st Century

Public Legislative Record

Washington SB 5355 · Montana SB 107 · North Dakota HB 1569 testimony · Nevada SB 131.

Writing / Research in Progress

Ignore the Fool: AI, Scientific Influence, and the Crisis of Validation in Publications and Platforms (forthcoming); *Credibility by Design* (Honors thesis in progress); 2026 IBM & NAA–STS Forum foreword and neutral institutional summary (forthcoming).

LANGUAGES & ADDITIONAL BACKGROUND

Languages

English, Hindi, Spanish; working study across Italian, Portuguese, Russian, German, and Japanese.

Classical Arts

Long-term training in Hindustani classical music and Kathak; earlier performance and teaching work documented in the site archive.

Public CV · Updated August 2026 · Direct email and private contact information intentionally omitted. Professional inquiries: riabahadur.com/contact/